

SOLD OUT

Of post birthday celebrations and photo opportunities gone awry

With the closing of our anniversary issue, you would think we could kick back our shoes, and stretch our tired fingers. We thought so too, but we were soon corrected. No sooner had we blinked our tired eyes, the news flooded in...we were all sold out...within days of reaching the newsstands. Our circulation colleagues, Saurabh and Akhilesh were swamped with orders from various distributors for more bulk copies. Phone calls poured in from all the cities asking if we had any copies stacked up. Clients clamoured for their promised copies. The basements of our offices were searched for an orphan copy that may have been left behind. None were found and our personal in-house copies were sent to the rescue.

Now we're always looking for a reason to celebrate, if this wasn't a reason enough, what could be? Our CEO, Maulik commissioned a duo of Musketeers to get cakes and sweets. And go they did, only to return with confectionaries enough for a team of six. Eighty ravenous eyes spotted the goodies from a distance, formed groups and

discussed, discarded and adopted various lines of attack as we assembled in the canteen. Their concentration did not leave the table as our CEO went through his congratulatory speech. Our marketing whiz Louis had the dangerous task of cutting the cake, barely managing to get a lick of the cake stuck to the



ILLUSTRATION: Mahesh Benkar

knife. Most strode towards the cake with stoic determination while others marked pace towards the table with the expertise of chess moves. Still others had managed to strategically place themselves at the table that the cake was placed at. The meek amongst us resorted to making

longing, vulnerable faces in the hope that some kind soul would toss a crumb!

Keepers of the copy

Meanwhile, e-mails poured in wishing us a happy birthday and congratulating us on the good job done, subtly sneaking in a request for a copy. Readers wondered if we were late. One reader who proudly proclaims to be a 'Digitised Dignitary' wrote in saying, "This month's Anniversary issue is a SMASHING sell-out. It really knocked me off my feet! I was caught unawares because I had this assurance that I would get it even after three days of hitting the stands, despite being prewarned. After 2 hours and seven shops I finally got my hands on the golden Digit." Many even wrote in to ask if we had any copies spare, like this one reader who worded the whole ordeal of his search in a long, long mail, finally saying, "Can you please tell me if you have any copies of June 2002 Digit magazine, so that I can directly buy it from you?" Subscribers offered to pay extra for another copy, while long lost friends traced our team members, refreshed memories and casually asked to borrow the issue.

We woke up from our celebration to realise that we didn't have enough in-house copies of the blue-eyed anniversary baby amongst ourselves. Soon every one on the team was guarding their copies with the eyes of a tigress. Each personal copy was labelled, chaperoned and just fell short of being leashed. The copydesk copy became a coveted issue, with everyone, from marketing to design to the ZDNetIndia team borrowing it for reference. Sveta, our soft spoken features editor, took it upon herself to call out for it every hour or so, booming out, "Who's got the anniversary issue?" Each request for it was met with a stern, "But we want it back. Immediately!" We conspired to put a tracking device on it which would beep when anyone came within inches of it. At night, the copy was snugly put to bed in a locked drawer. 

Behind the Picture

The test scene for the digital camera shootout was made up of various objects like fruits, watches and table-top calendars. Being the industrious types, the folks in the Test Centre went around office demanding (and at times threatening) colleagues for their watches and table calendars. Some even decided to visit the local *sabji mandi* to select the right fruits with the most vibrant colours. The stage was set up in our photo studio, with the lights meticulously placed and adjusted, the fruits, watches and calendars all ready to be shot over the next few days.

But one can only dream of everything going as per plans. The team forgot that fruits, unlike wristwatches and calendars have this nature-induced habit of decaying. So the fresh, juicy fruits chosen for their vibrant colours, turned black before the shoot was over. Tired of waiting, impatient owners claimed back their watches, without telling the team. Calendars found their way to their respective desks, much to the annoyance of the photographers. The scene spoilt, they had to start all over again, assembling things back in place, making the perfect composition as the tight deadlines loomed over their heads. They were all set to shoot again when someone knocked over the lights. Taking in a deep relaxing breath, Jitenbhai (our resident photographer) went out to buy new ones, while his colleague Mexy guarded the photo studio fort, making sure nothing else went missing, rotten or wrong.

But perseverance paid, and in the end the test centre writers had the images they needed.